

STRENGTH & POWER

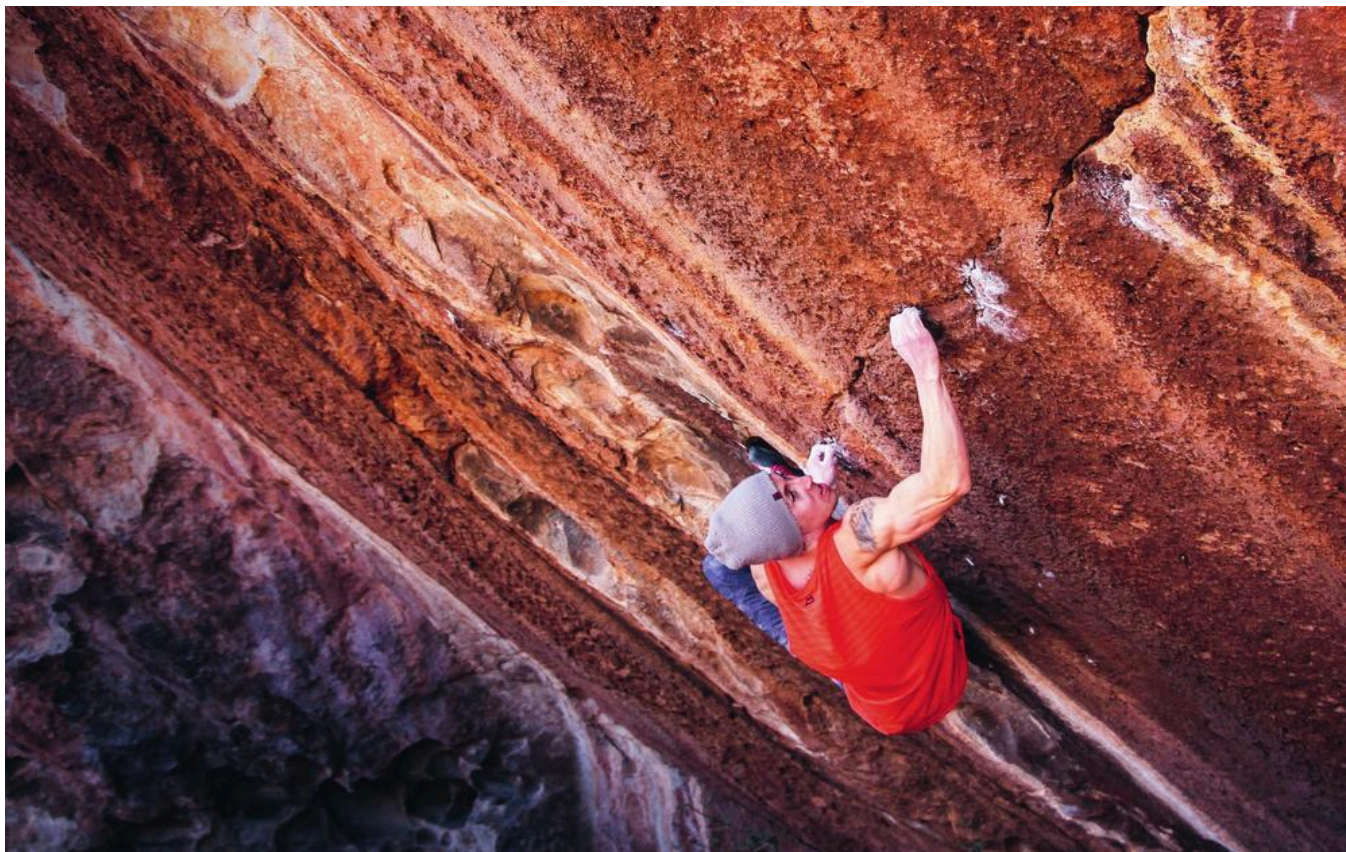


PHOTO: THILO SCHRÖTER

Stian Christophersen on *Slashface* (Font 8b), Hueco Tanks, USA.



Making every try count and taking enough time to rest is important. This second point in particular is often overlooked – even by us. Always ask yourself, ‘Am I ready for another go now?’ If the answer is yes, rest another minute or two, and then have a go with maximum effort.

BECOMING A STRONGER climber is a natural goal for most of us. Finger strength in relation to body weight is probably the most important physical factor for performance and one of the strongest indicators of what level we’re climbing at. But gripping holds isn’t the only thing we do on the wall. We also have to move between the holds, using the strength from our arms, upper body and what we can call our *core*.^{*} In some cases, we need to move quickly, at other times as calmly as possible, and there’s a difference between what is required of us physically when climbing on walls that are 60 degrees overhanging versus 15 degrees overhanging. In order to become a better and more complete climber we therefore have to work on improving multiple different factors, and the exercises in this chapter will guide you through methods of doing exactly that.

To begin with, we would like to clarify certain aspects within strength training. The number of repetitions is almost irrelevant, as training will make you stronger as long as you are tired after each set. This means you can vary the *dosage* of each exercise and adapt it to what the focus is of that particular training session.[‡] How hard each repetition is, or how hard each individual move is, will influence how many repetitions or moves you’ll be able to complete for each set, and here it’s important to consider what you’re actually training for. If your goal is to improve your maximum strength so you can do harder moves, boulder problems or crux sections on a route, it’s more relevant to train at maximum effort with fewer repetitions. If your goal is to build a more general base so that you become stronger and can endure more training, it will be more relevant with a higher training *volume*.[‡]

Volume and effort must also be considered in relation to resting times. In general, the closer you are to maximum effort, the longer your rests should be. The dosage we have suggested for the following exercises is not set in stone, and should therefore be used only as a guide, based on what we feel will be more efficient in terms of becoming a stronger and better climber. As we stated in *The Climbing Bible*, training individualisation is an important principle, and this is also valid here.

Another important aspect to be aware of when it comes to strength training is the relationship between force and velocity. How much force a muscle can generate is dependent on how fast it has to contract, and with an increase in velocity there will be a decrease in the rate of force development. The ability to rapidly develop force is therefore different to developing force in static positions or during slower movements. We call this ability *power* or *explosive strength*, and we define it as the product *force x velocity*. Power is important in climbing, especially for boulderers, as they often have to create a lot of force quickly in order to perform a dynamic move. Additionally, the momentum has to be stopped when landing the next hold. With the value of power in climbing in mind, our training goal should be twofold: becoming stronger, and becoming faster. And for this reason, we have chosen to split the exercises in this chapter into strength and power. The primary difference between the two being the velocity at which the movements should be performed, but also how physically strenuous they are. Power is trained at maximum velocity in the movements and maximum effort in the landings and with less resistance or load than traditional strength training.

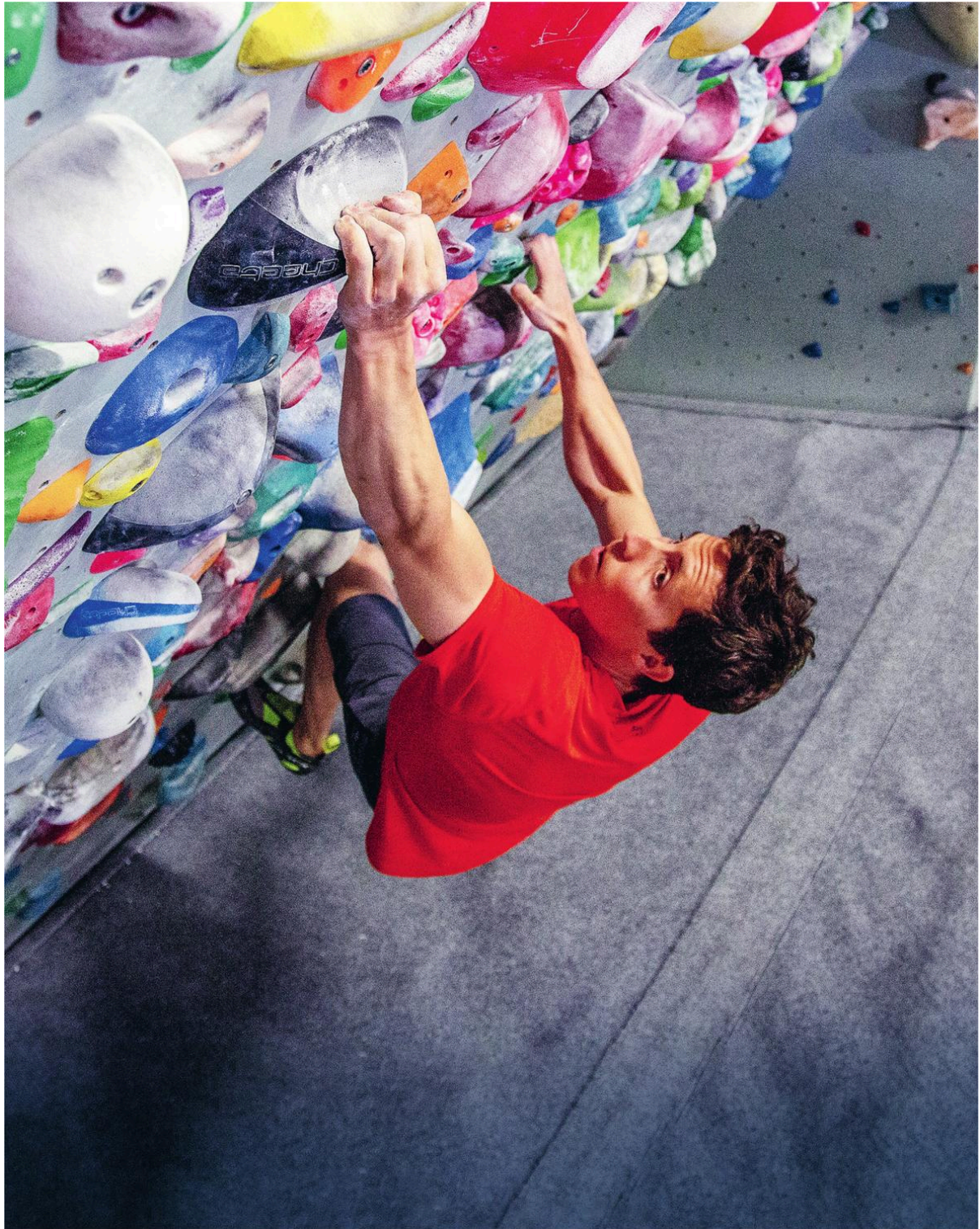
* Core is a term that normally describes the stomach and back. Us climbers could argue that the core is everything from the tips of our toes to the tips of our fingers, as we are dependent on maintaining a body position while moving an arm or a leg. However, for simplicity, we will still define the core as the musculature of the stomach and back.

† Dosage is the number of kg/intensity of each move x number of repetitions x number of sets per exercise.

‡ Volume is the number of repetitions x number of sets per exercise.

EXERCISES ON THE WALL

IN THIS PART we will cover exercises you can do on the climbing wall. By using the climbing wall as an arena for strength training you will include all the movement components that make up a climbing move. So, in addition to becoming stronger, you will also become better at moving and gain more from the training than if you were to only train strength through isolated exercises.



IMPORTANT CONSIDERATIONS FOR GETTING THE MOST OUT OF YOUR STRENGTH TRAINING

WHEN PLANNING TO train specific abilities during a session it's imperative that you're familiar with the training facilities. If your goal is to train finger strength on the bouldering wall, you either have to know which boulder problems are suitable for this, or you have to make up your own problems. Many climbing walls have their own training walls with a good selection of holds but without any pre-taped/set problems. This gives you the

opportunity to make up problems that fit your exact needs for a session. Making up your own problems also has the added benefit of training your understanding of movements, so if your local wall has a section like this we highly recommend using it as much as possible.



When you're making up boulder problems for sessions like this it's easier to choose equally sized holds that have an equal distance between them. If you can do one move with a slight margin, you can do four to six similar moves. To begin with you can use any footholds. As you get more proficient in making up problems, you can up the complexity by choosing specific footholds.

The most important aspects to consider if you're focusing on physical training when bouldering are grip type, the lengths of moves and wall angles. If your goal is finger strength, you should be climbing on small edges or pinches. If you're focusing on compression strength, you should climb on poorer holds that don't allow you to release tension between the holds. If you want to direct your training towards upper body and arm strength in order to be better at pulling through, the holds should be good enough for you to do the moves without matching.

As the walls get steeper, the more physically demanding it becomes for your fingers, arms and upper body, and you'll get less help from your legs. For less experienced climbers it can be challenging to train finger strength on walls steeper than 30 degrees, as the holds have to be relatively good just to be able to hang on. In this situation, walls steeper than 30 degrees can be used for training the arms, upper body and core, while less steep walls can be used for finger strength training as you then can allow yourself to use poorer holds. As you become stronger and more experienced, you'll be able to use poorer holds on steeper walls and hence increasingly be able to combine your training.

You can also use the size of the moves – the distance between the holds – as a variable. When doing short moves on bad holds, you can focus more on finger strength and tension between the fingers and toes, as the holds are too poor for you to cut your feet loose. Big moves on steep walls will require most of us to use relatively good holds independently of whether we're moving fast or slow between the holds, and the training will mostly target the arms, upper body and core rather than finger strength. Significantly increasing the distance between the holds is also a simple way to target power in your training.

To show how you can train specific elements on the bouldering wall, Stian will share some of his experiences from his own training:

MOVING SLOWLY WHEN YOU'RE GOOD AT MOVING FAST!

When I started climbing, I wasn't physically strong, neither in my fingers, nor in my arms or upper body. I was a rather petite little kid, something which isn't necessarily bad for climbing in general, but steep climbing and physically demanding positions definitely and literally weren't my strength. This wasn't something I reflected on too much when I was younger, and slowly but surely I developed a dynamic climbing style because this allowed me to solve harder moves by moving faster between holds. As I grew taller and stronger, I was able to do bigger moves on smaller holds. The dynamic style of climbing suited me well for bouldering and redpointing sport routes, but still I knew I had to become stronger. I had to become stronger in my fingers, stronger at moving slowly between holds and stronger at holding positions, so that I could lock off when the holds were too poor to do the moves while carrying a lot of speed.

So, one winter I decided to really focus on this, both through specific strength training and especially through my climbing. I made up steep boulder problems, removed any technical trickery like heel and toe hooks, and tried to climb with much less speed than what I normally would do. For example, I would try to lock off for a couple of seconds for every move, pulling slowly and steadily through a move without matching, or start the movement from down below and keep my feet on the wall throughout the problem. Over the course of the winter I noticed a gradual progression, but, rather worryingly, I also noticed I was doing worse on the not-so-steep climbing. Had I been training so much on my weaknesses that I had forgotten about my strengths? I couldn't find the natural flow and dynamic way of moving I was used to, and I noticed that I was making use of the slower movement pattern when I strictly didn't need to. When I realised this, I chose to create a more noticeable distinction in my training. I became more conscious of climbing dynamically and without restraining my technique for most of my climbing training, but I continued focusing on my weaknesses as a specific part of my training sessions.

I have on multiple occasions experienced that training our weaknesses can have a negative impact on our strengths, and albeit not as obvious as on this occasion it still emphasises the point – know thyself. Know your strengths and optimise them. Acknowledge what parts of your climbing you need to improve in order to progress, considering the physical, technical and mental factors. The trick is to maintain a balance between training your strengths and your weaknesses, and thereby develop your skills as a climber, step by step, for many years to come.

STRENGTH EXERCISES

MOUSE MOVES

The ability to hold on to small holds is one of the hallmarks of hard climbing and requires a great deal of finger strength. For this exercise you'll choose (or make up) one or more boulder problems on small holds with short moves. All the holds should be roughly the same size, all the moves roughly as hard, and you should be able to climb them with a controlled movement tempo. The focus should not be on pulling far or creating speed, but rather on using holds so small they barely enable you to hang on and move between them.

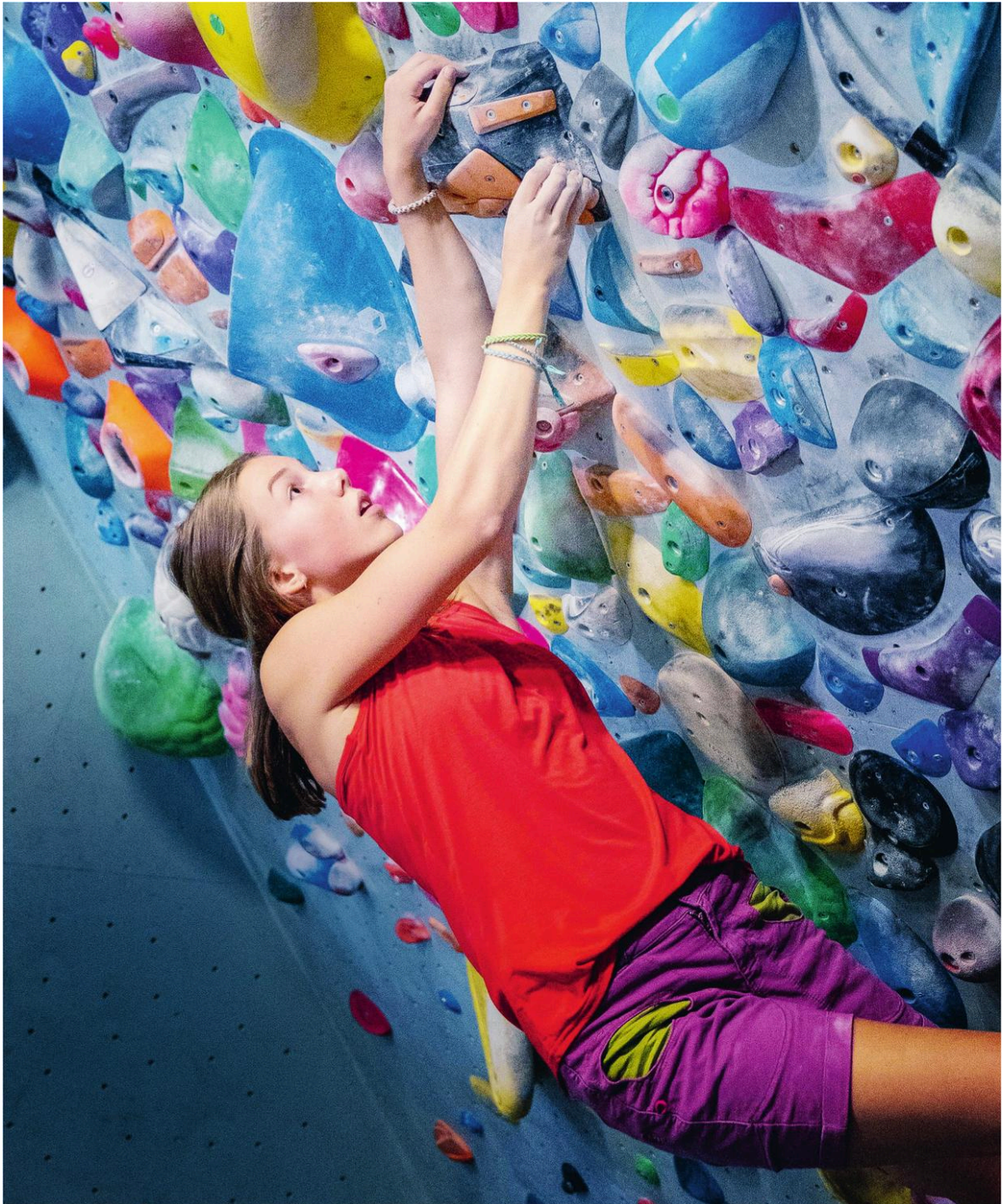
NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

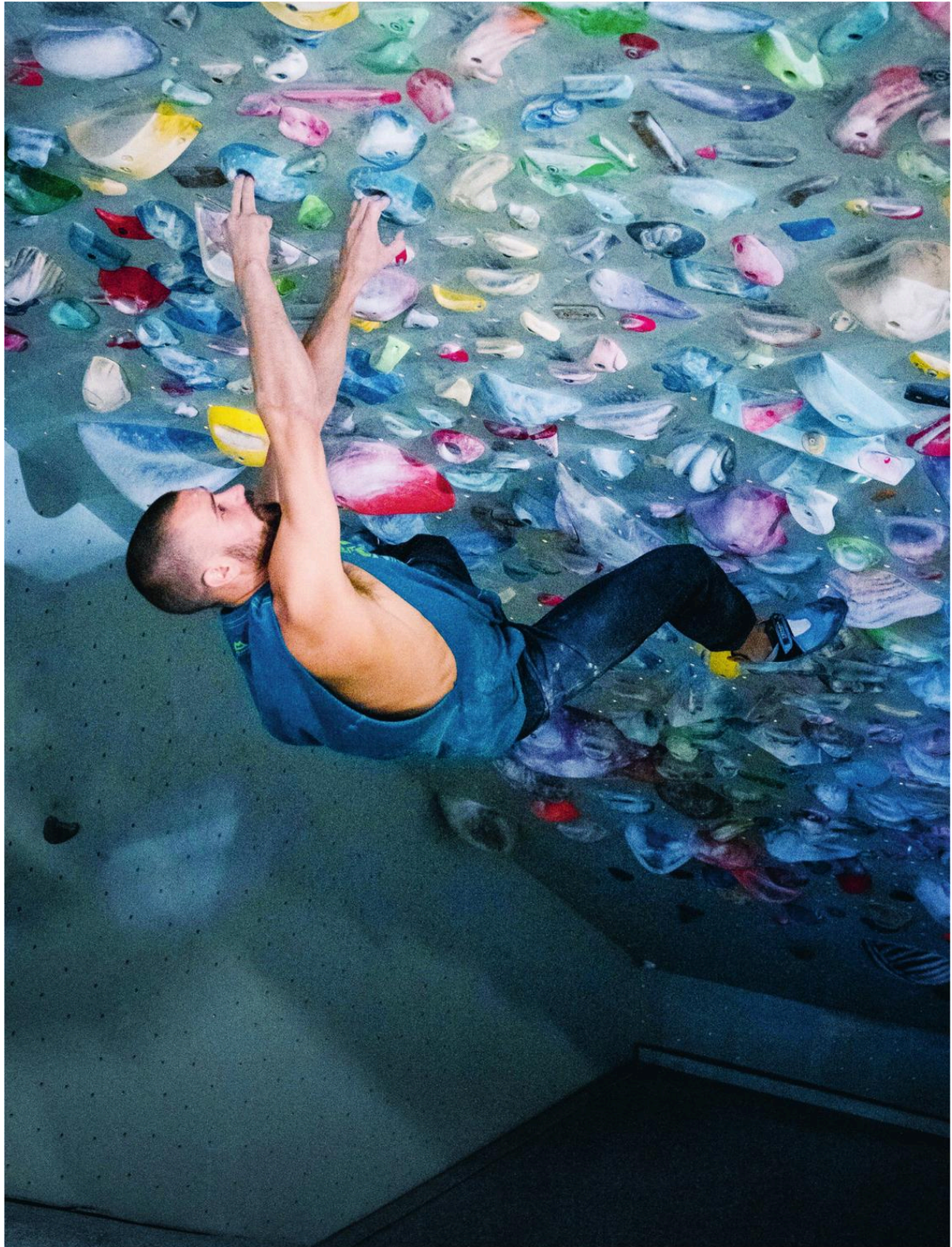
NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, preferably 5 tries on 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: small edges, pockets



When you start training, we recommend using large, positive footholds.



THEMED BOULDERING

We're often stronger or weaker with different grip positions, and by making up problems with different themes we can choose to train specifically on both our strengths and our weaknesses. Make up problems consisting solely of pinches, edges, slopers or pockets. It can be a good idea to vary between different grip types throughout the session as this will increase both the technical and the physical benefits of the session and reduce the risk of injury caused by uniform training.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 5 to 6

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, preferably 5 tries on 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: small edges, pinches, pockets, slopers

4x4

This is a hard exercise where you'll have a lot of tries on relatively hard problems. In addition to becoming stronger, you'll also be improving your capacity so that you'll be able to climb longer boulder problems at your maximum level and be able to have more tries on your project per session. Choose four different problems, preferably with different grip types, movement patterns and wall angles. Climb problems one, two, three and four with a 60-second rest in between each problem. After problem four take a 3- to 5-minute rest and then repeat the whole process three more times so that in total you'll have 16 tries (four tries per problem). Since the resting time between each problem is short, the problems shouldn't be too close to your maximum level, so choose problems where you have enough of a margin so that you're able to rest enough between each try.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 16 (4 tries on each problem on a circuit of 4 problems)

WALL ANGLE: vertical to roof, 1 problem per angle

HOLDS: varied





FEET ON THE WALL

We often see climbers falling because their feet cut loose on steep walls and they swing off. To avoid this, you need tension in your body from your fingers to your toes so that your feet remain stuck to the wall. This requires strength in your arms, upper body and core – we call this *body strength*. To train this specific body strength you should climb steep boulder problems where you're not allowed to cut loose. Start with good handholds and footholds to maintain control of the movements, and then use poorer handholds, and finally use poorer footholds.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 5 to 6

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, preferably 5 tries on 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 40 degrees and steeper

HOLDS: start with good holds, then make them as bad as possible as you progress

CAMPUSING

Footless climbing, or campusing, is a simple and fun way to train strength. For this exercise you'll be climbing problems without using your feet, which will obviously make it significantly harder for your fingers, arms and upper body.

If you've never done any campus training before, we recommend you begin with short moves on good holds so that you become strong enough to control the movements. Focus on landing the holds with your elbows slightly bent and work on not extending your arms fully. Tighten up your body and focus especially on your core, as it's important to maintain tension in order to avoid unnecessary rotations.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 4 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 total, on 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 40 degrees and steeper

HOLDS: varied



PROW

If your local climbing wall has a prow, climbing it without using your feet will be good compression strength training. Use sloping holds that require you to squeeze and press your hands in towards each other in order to hang on.



SLOW MOVES

Use good holds and do the moves as slowly as you can. The focus here is on arm and upper body strength.



You should be able to do five pull-ups before you start campus training.



SHORT MOVES

Use closely spaced bad holds in order to train finger strength. The focus here is not on pulling far or creating speed, but rather on using holds so small they barely enable you to hang on and move between them.



It's best to find a really steep wall to begin with. The less steep the wall, the more you will have to pull up for each move, and that's exactly what makes this hard.



COMPRESSION

Compressing between holds is when you're squeezing the palms of your hands towards each other against opposite-facing hold surfaces. The compression disappears when you let go with one hand, so you quickly have to move to the next hold to regain the compression between the holds. This places special demands on your upper body strength and should be trained specifically. In this exercise we therefore want you to choose, or make up, different boulder problems where you actively have to work with compression. If you choose holds on each side of a prow or an edge this will usually involve compression, and so this is a good place to start.

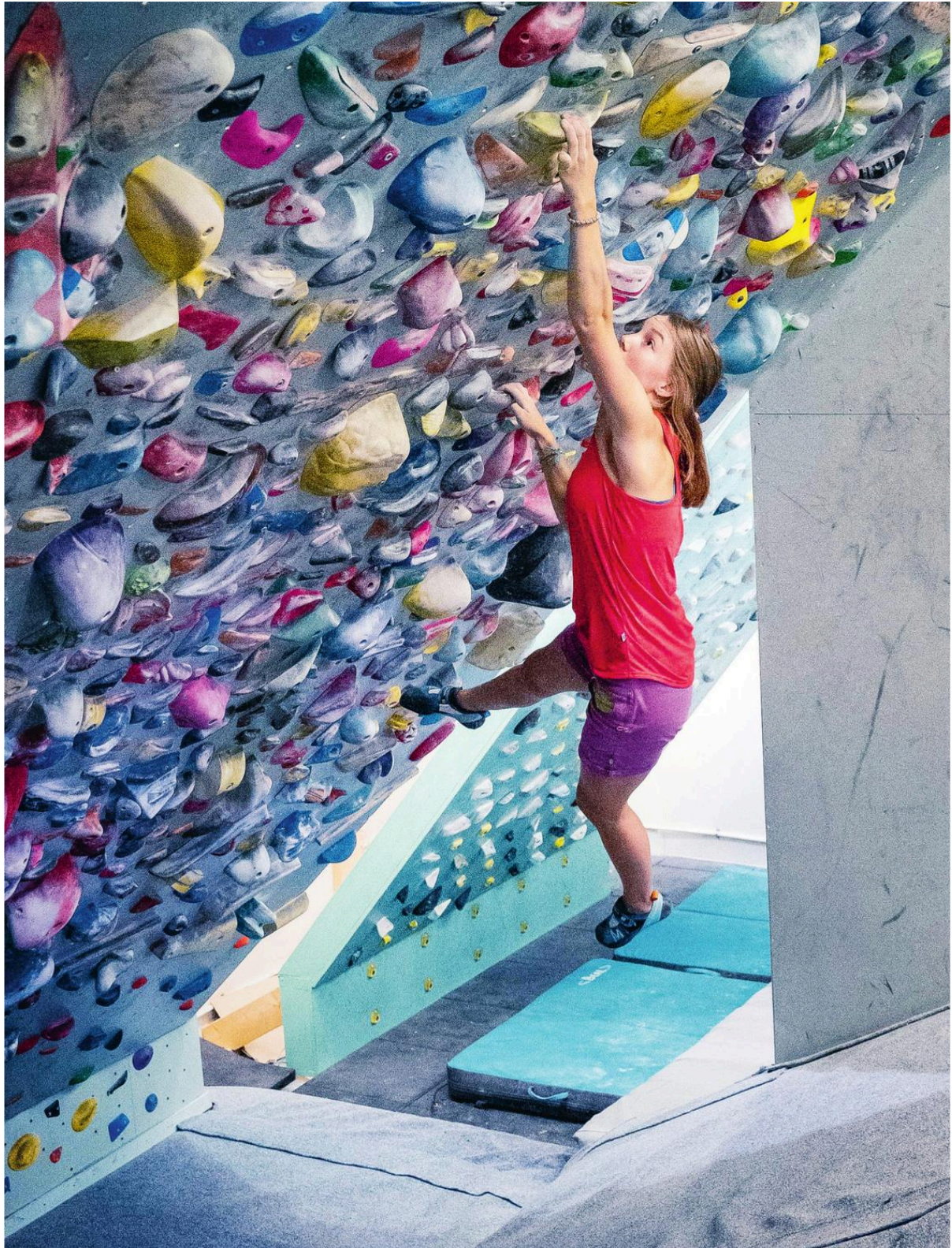
NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to roof

HOLDS: hold surfaces that face away from each other; slopers will be the most effective



PULLING THROUGH

We're all familiar with the feeling of landing a hold, but not being able to pull through to the next. Sometimes we're able to match, but it is an extremely valuable physical ability to be able to pull through using just one arm. You can train this by doing long moves on relatively good holds, while avoiding matching. Then you can train pulling through on one arm for every move.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: good holds

POSITIONING EXERCISES

BY CLIMBING ON boulder problems that consist solely or mostly of either undercuts, sidepulls or upward-facing holds, you can specifically address the requirements for positioning that these holds force you to consider. When you begin this training we recommend using relatively good holds, so that the focus of your training is on your arms, upper body and core. You can narrow this focus down even further by choosing steeper walls. Then you can move on to less steep walls and poorer holds to shift the focus towards finger strength, before finally being strong enough to combine small holds and steep walls. Most boulder problems and routes will require you to adapt to multiple different positions, but you can train each part specifically as described in the following exercises.



PHOTO: ISAK HUNGNES

Martin Mobråten sending *Shantaram* (Font 8b+/c) on Ramsøya outside of Vingsand, Norway.



FRONTING

Choose holds that are positioned as close to horizontal on the wall as possible. Eliminate all other techniques, like twisting in, and heel and toe hooks, and perform every move as controlled as you can while fronting the wall. This requires strength in your arms and shoulders, because your arms are angled away from the wall. The wider the positions and the greater the distance between the holds, the harder the exercise will be. You should therefore vary the distance between the holds both vertically and horizontally.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive and relatively good holds



Remember your pinkie! Use four fingers on the hold as this will automatically activate the shoulder and arm to a greater extent.



TWISTING IN

Choose sidepulls that are as close to vertical as possible and twist in for every move. This means twisting your right hip in towards the wall when moving your right arm, and vice versa.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive and relatively good holds



GASTON

Choose holds where the grip surface is facing in towards the middle, and do every move as a shoulder press, or gaston. The more vertical the holds, the harder the moves will be. You can either front or twist in, but your arm and hand will be working in the same position the whole time.

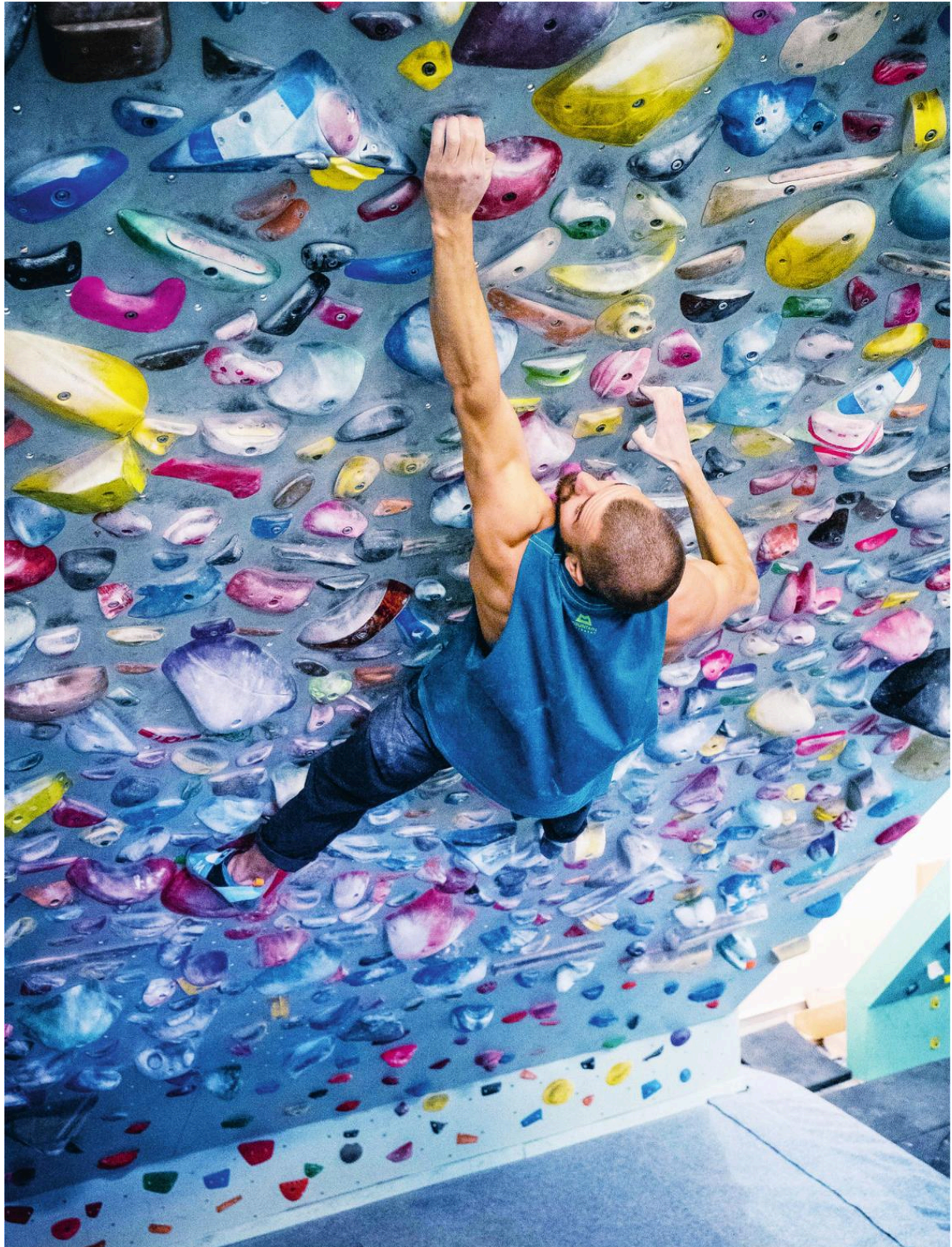
NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive and relatively good holds



LOCKING OFF

In many cases, handholds can be so small, undefined or bad that it's hard to land them correctly when carrying too much speed. Therefore, it's important to have the necessary strength to be able to lock off in your arms and body to grab the next hold in control. Choose a steep boulder problem on good holds. Lock off for 2 to 3 seconds with your free hand hovering just above the next hold before grabbing it, and repeat this for every move.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 4 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 3 to 5 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive and relatively good holds



TURTLE

We are stronger in some body positions and at some arm angles than others. By moving to the next hold at a steady pace you can train the parts of the movement where you aren't as strong. The holds should be relatively good, so that you're able to pull through the move in a steady and controlled fashion. Focus on moving at roughly the same speed throughout the entire move.

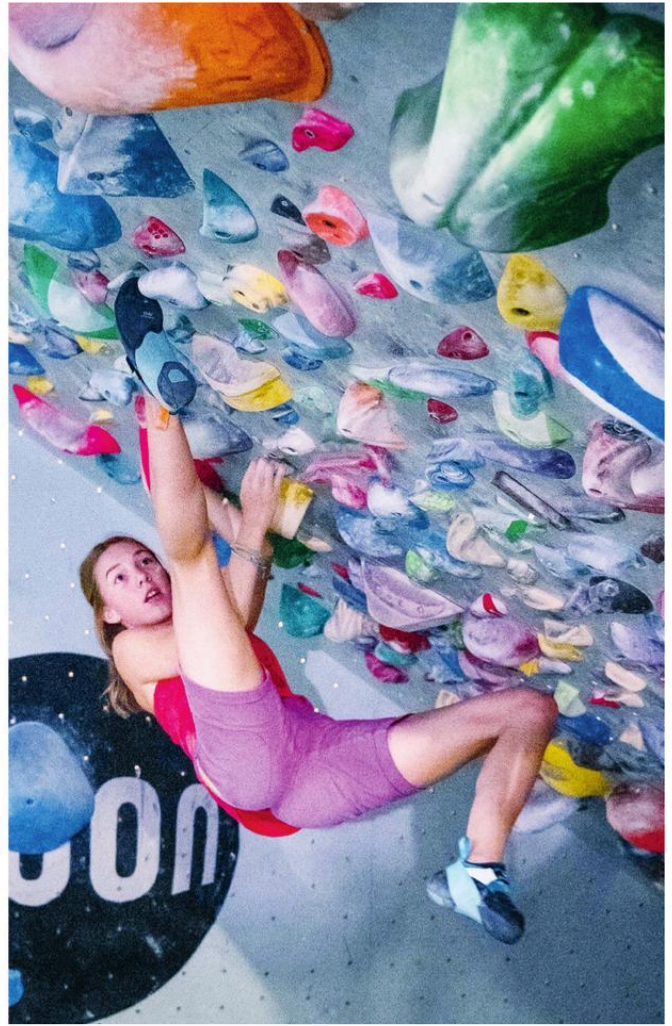
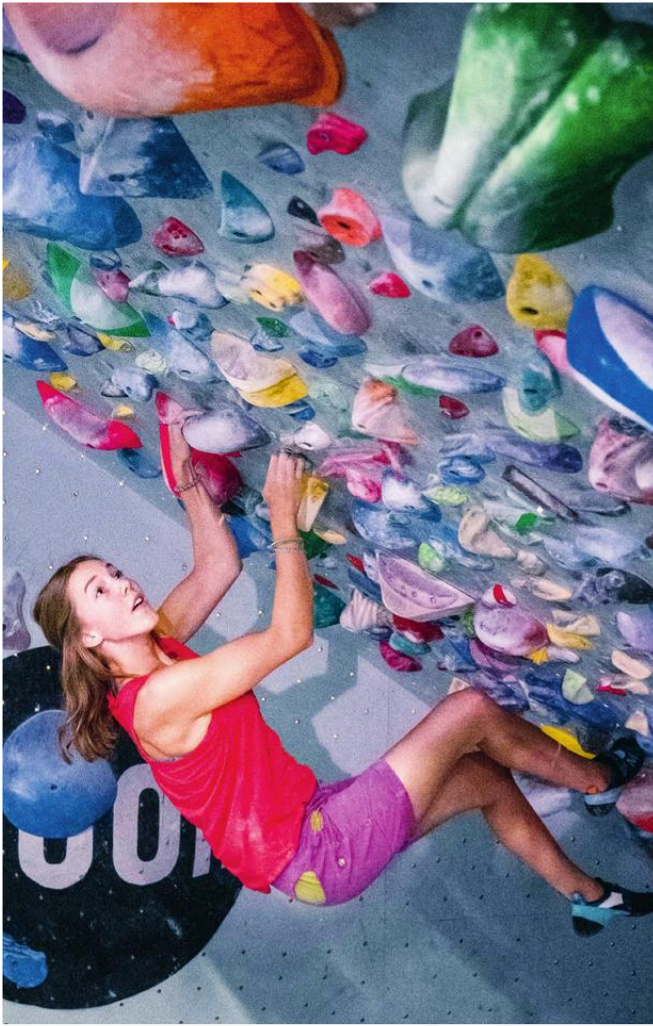
NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 10 total, on 2 to 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: vertical to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive and relatively good holds



MARKING

Marking holds with your feet is a good way to train your core, in addition to it being hard for your arms. Choose steep walls and make up a boulder problem with good holds. Cut your feet loose and touch the next handhold with one of your feet. Place your feet back down on the footholds you were standing on and then move to the next hold. Repeat for every move.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 4 to 6

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 10 total, on 2 to 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 60 degrees overhanging to roof

HOLDS: jugs



If it's too difficult to cut your feet loose, you can walk them up to the hold you're aiming for by using any and all footholds, and then walk them back down.



HANG ON

Taking a swing is hard work for the whole body. The quicker you can stop it, the better your chances are of hanging on to the holds. After stopping the swing, you then have to get your feet back on to the wall, which is yet another hard move. This exercise trains both parts.

Use holds on a steep wall or a lip.* Swing your feet in and stop the movement by placing your feet on one or two footholds; hold this position for a few seconds. Cut your feet loose and repeat. Make the exercise harder by using poorer holds or by increasing the distance between the handholds and footholds.

* A lip is the edge between two wall angles, for example when a roof transitions over to a vertical wall.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 6 to 8 swings

REST: minimum 3 minutes

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 to 6

WALL ANGLE: 45 degrees to roof

HOLDS: varied



ON THE LIMIT

As the title implies, you'll be climbing boulder problems that are at the limit of your ability. The possibilities are endless in terms of wall angles, grip types, grip size and lengths of moves. This is a good opportunity to climb problems with different themes, as described earlier in the book, and be conscious of how you train your strengths, weaknesses, or even both in one session.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 3 to 6

REST: minimum 4 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 10 total, on 2 to 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 15 degrees overhanging to roof

HOLDS: varied



You should make up and try problems in advance so that you know they are at the right level for the session, and so that you know them well enough to have consistently good, high-quality tries.



AMERICAN STYLE

‘American style’ is a dynamic climbing style with lots of big moves, dynos and swings. You should create a lot of speed from down low and land the next hold with your arms bent. Sticking the hold and taking the swing will be the hardest part, and you should focus on keeping your arms bent and making the swing as short as possible. This exercise requires a great deal of strength in the arms, upper body, stomach and back. We recommend starting off with fewer moves per problem to consistently maintain a high quality for every move.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 3 to 6

REST: minimum 4 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 15 total, on 2 to 3 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 45 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: positive holds

POWER EXERCISES

JUMP START

How fast you're able to close your hand as you grab a hold and how fast you're able to stop your body's momentum are important abilities when it comes to hard climbing, and especially bouldering. For this exercise you'll start standing on the ground. Grab a hold with one hand and jump to another hold with your free hand. Work on landing the next hold with your arms slightly bent, and stiffen your body from your fingertips and throughout your whole upper body as you land the hold. The hold you're jumping to should be so bad that you're only just able to stop the momentum and hold the position for 2 to 3 seconds. To make the exercise harder, you can choose poorer holds or increase the distance between them.

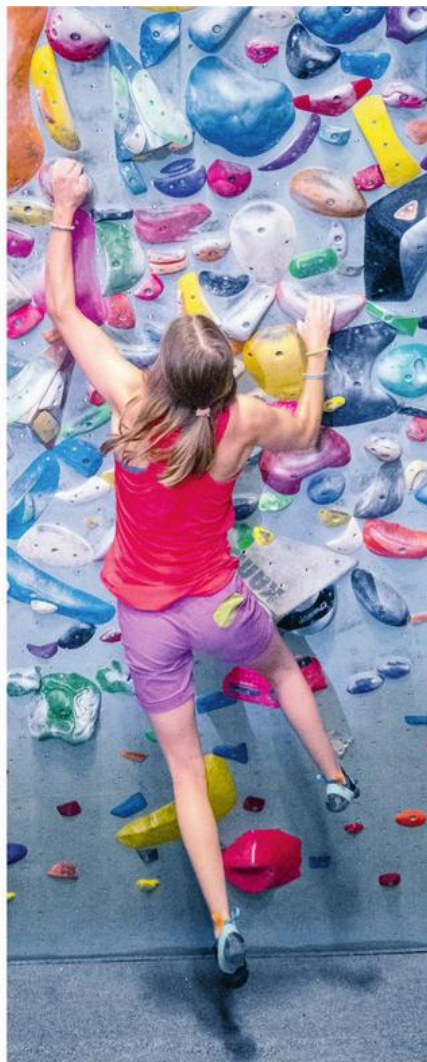
NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 1

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 per hand, on 3 separate problems

REST: 5 seconds between each jump, 2 minutes between each problem

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: varied



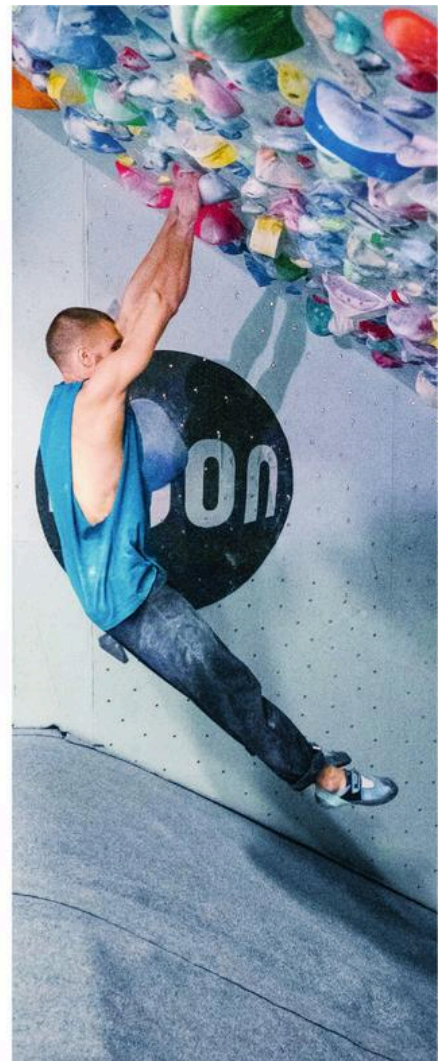
VARIATIONS:

- You can start with both one hand and one foot on the wall and kick. This is what we call a '[kick start](#)' and it will make it easier to increase the distance to the hold you're aiming for. Kick starts often require a higher degree of finger and upper body strength than a jump start.
- You can also jump from the ground with both hands to one or two holds. As you land the hold, or holds, they should be so bad that you're only just able to stop the momentum and hold the position for 2 to 3 seconds. You

can start by jumping straight up, but after a while you can try to start from slightly further in, forcing you to jump backwards. This will increase the swing which will be harder to hold.



As you become strong enough, the best way to do the exercise is by jumping to edges or pinches.



DYNOS

Unlike the jump start and kick start, you now have to create the upwards momentum from a position on the wall. This movement is much more technically complicated and will also demand more pulling strength from the arms and upper body in the starting phase. Additionally, it will require strength in the fingers and arms/upper body as you land the hold you're aiming for. The steeper the wall, the harder it gets. Start on vertical walls and work your way up from there.



THREE POINTS OFF

Start from good holds and dyno to a hold you might struggle a bit to hold, while not letting go with your lower hand. Work on landing the move with your arms slightly bent and stopping your body's momentum. Sticking the upper hold will require finger strength, and landing with your arms bent and stopping the swing will require arm and upper body strength. To increase the difficulty of this exercise you can make both the start holds and the hold you're dynoing to poorer, and then you can increase the distance between them.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 1

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 per hand, on 3 separate problems

REST: 10 to 20 seconds between each dyno, 2 minutes between each problem

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 60 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: varied starting and top holds



ALL POINTS OFF

Start from bad holds in a challenging starting position and dyno as far as you can to the next hold. The hold you're aiming for can be a good one, and you can lose all points of contact except the arm you're landing with.

The focus is on creating momentum from a challenging, finger-intensive position. Getting established in the starting position will require finger strength, and initiating the dyno will require power in the rest of your body.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 1

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 per hand, on 3 separate problems

REST: 10 to 20 seconds between each dyno, 2 minutes between each problem

WALL ANGLE: 15 to 40 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: poor starting holds, good top holds



KANGAROO

Start with good holds and dyno as high as you can. Focus on covering as much distance as possible; you don't need to land and hang on to the next hold. This requires power in your arms, upper body and legs.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 1

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 tries, on 3 separate problems

REST: 10 to 20 seconds between each dyno, 2 minutes between each problem

WALL ANGLE: 10 to 40 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: good



MONKEY

Start with good holds, dyno as high as you can and land with either one or two hands on a good hold. This requires power in your arms, upper body and legs.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 1

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 12 tries, on 3 separate problems

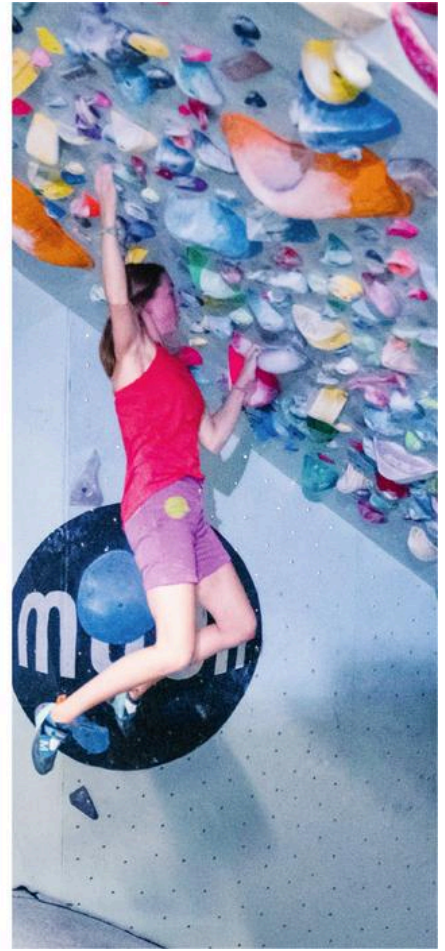
REST: 1 minute rest between each dyno

WALL ANGLE: 10 to 40 degrees overhanging

HOLDS: good

CAMPUSING

We have already described [footless climbing](#) for strength training. The focus for this exercise is to make the moves as big as possible and do them as quickly as possible. This will require rapid force development in both the start and end phases of the move.



GO BIG

Do big moves on good holds. Work on creating a lot of speed and landing with your arms bent. It's better to start with your arms relatively level in order to create an explosive move. You can therefore go big with one hand, match it with your other hand and then go big again with your other hand.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 2 to 4

REST: 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 to 12 tries, on 3 to 4 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 45 degrees overhanging to roof

HOLDS: jugs and positive edges and pinches



GO FAST

Do relatively short and simple campus moves as quickly as you can. Time yourself and try to improve every try. When your time starts to slow down, your set is complete.

NUMBER OF MOVES PER PROBLEM: 4 to 6

REST: 3 minutes

NUMBER OF TRIES IN TOTAL: 9 to 12 tries, on 3 to 4 separate problems

WALL ANGLE: 45 degrees overhanging to roof

HOLDS: jugs

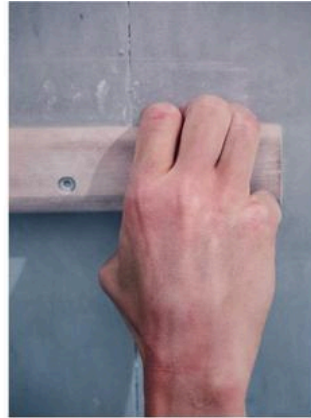
ISOLATED STRENGTH EXERCISES

THERE ARE MANY advantages to training strength on the climbing wall, but some physical properties are so essential that it can be a good idea to complement our training with some isolated exercises. This gives us the opportunity to target a select few elements at a time in a controlled fashion, and this might yield better results than

if we were to train them in combination with other elements. We recommend isolated exercises for finger, arm and core strength to improve performance on the wall and to reduce the risk of injury.



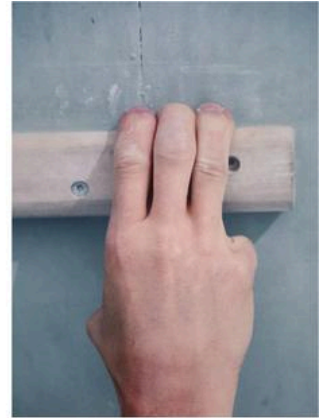
Back three



Front three



Open middle two



Open front three



Half crimp



Sloper

DEADHANGS

As we wrote in *The Climbing Bible*, deadhangs are one of the most specific and controllable methods we have for training finger strength. Previously, specific finger training has been considered very risky with regard to sustaining finger injuries, both for younger and older climbers, but this entirely comes down to the training method and how high the training dosage is. Finger strength training can be done using safe and controlled methods, which, all in all, will put the climber at a lower risk of injury than a regular climbing session. In addition, systematic finger strength training will over time also strengthen muscles, tendons, joints and ligaments, further reducing the risk of injury. What's important is to conduct the training with proper technique and in control, and focus on the training dosage – as in how much and how hard you train per session, per week, and over a longer period.

In *The Climbing Bible* we presented a small selection of exercises for finger strength training. Here we present further methods for training different properties, to ensure progression and variation in your finger strength training.

If you were to choose to train only one grip position, we recommend training using the half crimp. This is more usable for most holds and is also more specific than the open-handed grip when it comes to using small holds, something which is usually the case when it comes to hard climbing. Still, it's wise to vary the grip positions so that you also become stronger when using an open-handed grip, and on slopers and pockets. The following exercises can be done using any grip position, but unless another grip position is specifically mentioned we recommend the half crimp as the standard grip position.

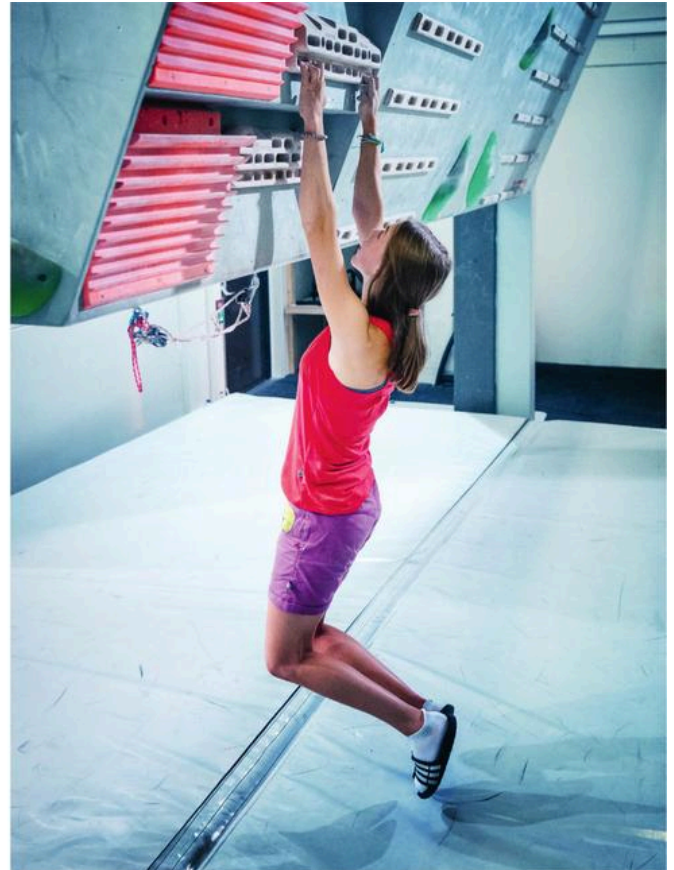


UNLOADING

In principle, anyone can train deadhangs, it's just a question of how much they need to unload from their body weight. For example, a climber weighing 70 kilograms can unload 35 kilograms and thereby train at half their body weight. This will allow them to train effectively and with control, focusing on proper technical execution and at a lower risk of injury compared to regular climbing. As you get more comfortable with the hanging position and can do each hang with a slight margin – meaning you can hang significantly longer than the number of seconds described for each exercise – you can gradually decrease the number of deloaded kilograms to ensure you're training at the correct load. In order to unload some body weight, we recommend using a simple pulley system with a harness and weights, as demonstrated in [this photo](#).



Remember to pull your shoulders down and rotate your elbows slightly in towards each other.



TORTURE HANGS

The goal for this exercise is to hang for 30 to 40 seconds per hang. Choose a grip position or an edge depth that only just enables you to hang for 30 to 40 seconds. If you can hang for more than 40 seconds, use poorer holds. You can start by hanging from a pull-up bar or from jugs and gradually work your way to hanging from poorer holds. Complete four to six hangs with a 2- to 3-minute rest between each hang.

HANG TIME: 30 to 40 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 to 6

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 to 3 minutes

MARGIN: none

* By *margin*, we mean how much longer you *could* have hung. If we say you should have a 3-second margin for a hang that should last 10 seconds, you should let go after 10 seconds, but have enough margin that you could have hung on for an additional 3 seconds. No margin means hang until exhaustion, meaning you're unable to hang on any longer.

REPEATERS 1

Choose four or five different grip positions, for example four finger half crimp, sloper, front three open grip and front three half crimp. Complete the following for each grip position: hang for 7 seconds, rest for 3 seconds, and do seven hangs, so that you're near exhaustion for the last (seventh) hang. Take a 2- to 3-minute rest and repeat for the remaining grip positions.

HANG TIME: 7 seconds

REST BETWEEN HANGS: 3 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 7

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 or 5

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 to 3 minutes

MARGIN: near exhaustion for the last hang of each set

REPEATERS 2

Choose one grip position which you wish to improve and do the following: hang for 10 seconds, rest for 5 seconds, and do four hangs, so that you're near exhaustion for the last hang. Take a 3- to 5-minute rest and complete another three sets. This is supposed to be a more challenging exercise than *Repeaters 1*, so the holds should be poorer, or you should unload less weight from or add more weight to your body weight.

HANG TIME: 10 seconds

REST BETWEEN HANGS: 5 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 4

NUMBER OF SETS: 4

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 to 5 minutes

MARGIN: near exhaustion for the last hang of each set



MAXIMUM WEIGHT

Start with relatively deep edges so that you're able to add extra weight. Use the half crimp and do the following: hang for 10 seconds, rest for 3 minutes, and do five hangs in total. Keep a margin of 1 to 3 seconds for each hang, so that you're able to maintain good grip and body posture throughout the whole hang, and so you can put your feet back on the ground while still in control after 10 seconds. If you're able to hang for more than 13 seconds you can add more weight.

HANG TIME: 10 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 5

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

MARGIN: 1 to 3 seconds



SHALLOW EDGE

Hang using a half crimp grip from the shallowest edges possible. Do the following: hang for 10 seconds, rest for 3 minutes, and do five hangs in total. Keep a margin of 1 to 3 seconds for each hang, so that you're able to maintain good grip and body posture throughout the whole hang, and so you can put your feet back on the ground while still in control after 10 seconds. If you're able to hang for more than 13 seconds you can choose an even shallower edge.

HANG TIME: 10 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 5

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

MARGIN: 1 to 3 seconds



SHORT AND HARD

This exercise can be done with either one or two hands, and with either added weight on deeper edges or without any added weight on as shallow edges as possible. Do the following: hang for 3 to 5 seconds, rest for 1 minute, and do six hangs in total. Focus on developing as much force as possible in the shortest amount of time, meaning you should pull as hard as you can for every hang. If you're able to hang for more than 5 seconds you will either have to add more weight, or make the hold worse, or remove some of the weight if you're deloading.

HANG TIME: 3 to 5 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 6

REST BETWEEN SETS: 1 minute

MARGIN: none

DEADHANGS

For experienced climbers who have been doing a lot of deadhang training with both hands, the one-handed deadhang can be the next natural step forward. Even if you're able to hang at full body weight from just one hand, we want to emphasise the usefulness of deloading. Hanging from one hand is a different technique than hanging from both, and it's wise to start with the right amount of deloading to make sure you're executing the exercise correctly and with control. Since your body will start to rotate around your arm when you're hanging from one hand, your free hand should be used to stop this rotation so that you're hanging without your body moving at all.

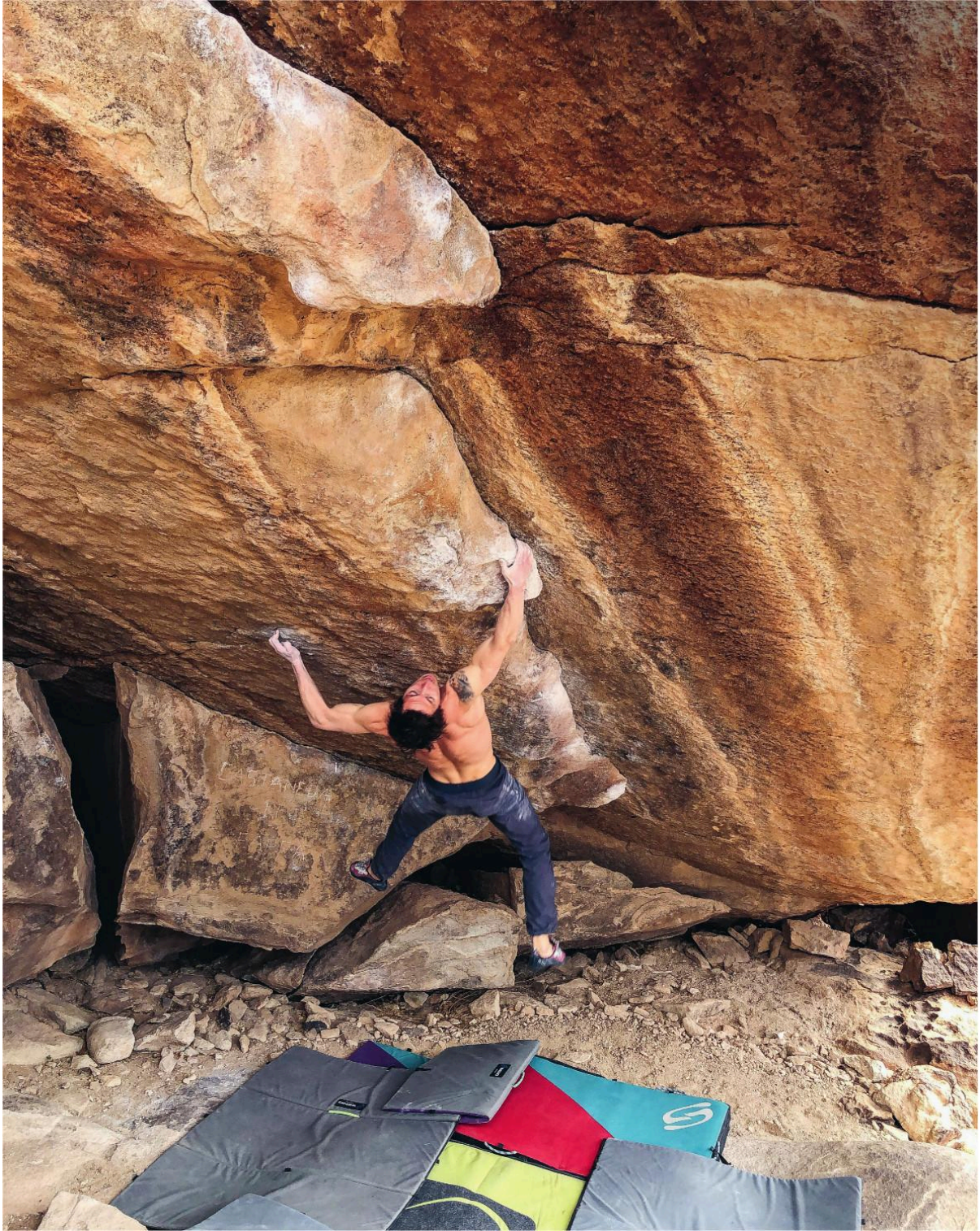


PHOTO: MARTIN MOBRÅTEN

Stian Christophersen sends *Power of Landjager* (Font 8a), Hueco Tanks, USA. Training both deadhangs and one-arm lock-offs can help you control your body's rotation and pull through with one arm without having to match.

EXERCISES USING A PORTABLE FINGERBOARD



THERE ARE SEVERAL portable fingerboard solutions if you're on a trip somewhere or for some other reason don't have access to a regular mounted fingerboard. All deadhang exercises can of course be done on these boards, but they will move about more as you hang from them. Another option is to attach weights to the end of the board and lift them instead. This will allow you to easily see how many kilograms you're able to load with. By doing it this way you can also use the same training methods as described in this chapter, although we recommend training one hand at a time so that you don't have to add so much weight.

Another training method that's suitable for portable boards is *finger curls*. This means starting in an open grip position and curling your fingers up into a crimp. This is dynamic strength training for your finger musculature and it's a good supplement to the more classic and static deadhang exercises. Do the following:

Find the load (number of kilograms) you're able to curl from an open hand into a crimp, such that you are near exhaustion after eight repetitions. Complete three sets per hand with a 3-minute rest between each set.

NUMBER OF CURLS PER SET: 8

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

MARGIN PER SET: 1 RIR*

* Repetition in reserve (RIR) is used as a measurement of intensity in dynamic strength training. It refers to how many more repetitions you feel you would be able to complete in a set. If RIR = 0 you're completely exhausted. The higher your RIR per set is, the further away you are from exhaustion. For strength training to have an effect on the force development in a muscle, your RIR should be no higher than 5.

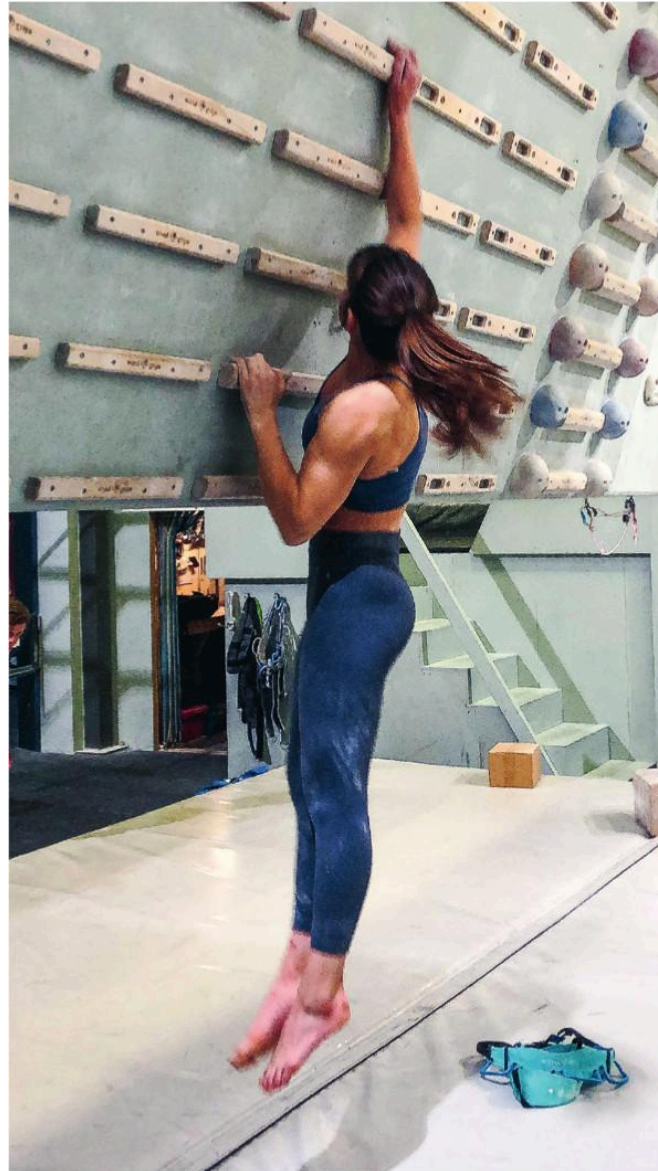


Start with less added weight than you think. This is a very hard exercise.

JUMP TO THE EDGE

An obvious factor for whether we're able to do a move or not, is how fast we're able to close our grip around the hold we're aiming for. This ability – being able to grip hard and fast – is probably more important in bouldering than in route climbing, but will in many instances be the deciding factor at the crux of a route. Earlier in the

chapter we described how this ability can be trained through the '[jump start](#)' and the '[kick start](#)', and we can do exactly the same exercise on the campus board.



VERSION 1

Hold a rung at shoulder height with one hand and jump as high as you can with the other hand in such a way that you're able to land the next rung with your arm slightly bent. Hold this position for 2 seconds, take a 5-second rest, and repeat six to eight times per arm.



VERSION 2

Jump from the ground and grab a rung with both arms slightly bent. Hold the position for 2 seconds, take a 5-second rest, and repeat six to eight times.



VERSION 3

Stand facing sideways to the campus board, jump from the ground and grab a rung with one hand. Vary the angle in your elbow so that you alternate between angles from slightly bent to 90 degrees. Hold the position for 2 seconds, take a 5-second rest, and repeat six to eight times per arm.

ARM & UPPER BODY STRENGTH EXERCISES

CLIMBING IS A *pulling-based* sport, and as the walls become steeper and the moves become longer, we are dependent on increasing our pulling strength. In this book we have deliberately planned for most of the arm and upper body strength training to take place on the climbing wall. Still, it can be appropriate to supplement this with some isolated pulling strength exercises, in different controlled and varied ways.

LOCK-OFFS

TWO-HANDED LOCK-OFFS

Hang from a bar or two jugs using both hands and with your arms bent. Hang until you're unable to hold the position. If you can't hold this position for more than a few seconds we recommend deloading using an elastic band or a pulley system, so that you're able to hang for around 10 seconds. Work your way up to hanging for 30 seconds. If you're able to hang for significantly longer than this, we recommend adding extra weight or moving on

to one-handed lock-offs. You can alternate between using overhand and underhand grips, and vary the angle of your elbows – how bent your arms are. We recommend training at different angles, from your elbows bent at 90 degrees to your arms almost fully extended.

HANG TIME: 30 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 to 6

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 minutes

MARGIN PER HANG: 2 to 3 seconds





ONE-HANDED LOCK-OFFS, TORTURE HANGS

Position yourself sideways with one hand on a bar or a jug, and your arm bent. In this exercise you will aim to hold this position for 15 seconds, so, if necessary, deload until this is possible. Again, we recommend training at different elbow angles, from 90 degrees to almost fully extended.

HANG TIME: 15 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 per arm

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 to 3 minutes

MARGIN PER HANG: none



ONE-HANDED LOCK-OFFS, MAX HANGS

Position yourself as per the previous exercise. You will now deload or add enough weight so that you are only just able to hang for a maximum of 5 seconds. Vary the angle of your elbows as per the previous exercise.

HANG TIME: 3 to 5 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 6 per arm

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 to 3 minutes

MARGIN PER HANG: 0 to 1 seconds



JUMP TO LOCK-OFF

This exercise can be done with either one or both hands. Stand on the ground and jump to a bar or a jug. Land at different elbow angles and hold the position for a couple of seconds. As a set you can do six of these jumps with a couple of seconds' rest in between each jump, and do three sets in total.

HANG TIME: 2 seconds

REST BETWEEN JUMPS: 2 to 5 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 6

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 minutes

MARGIN PER HANG: 1 to 3 seconds



CHALLENGE

Eat a banana or a donut or drink a cup of coffee while locking off on one arm, and challenge your friends to do the same. Can you eat or drink it all, and who can manage the biggest meal or cup?

PULL-UPS



REGULAR

Start by hanging from a bar or two jugs with your arms shoulder width apart. Start the movement by rotating your arms so that the insides of your elbows are facing in towards the middle, pull your shoulder blades down and towards each other and bend your elbows so that you can pull all the way up until your chin is above your hands. It can be a good idea to start by deloading a bit of weight to learn the technique properly and to increase the number of repetitions per set.

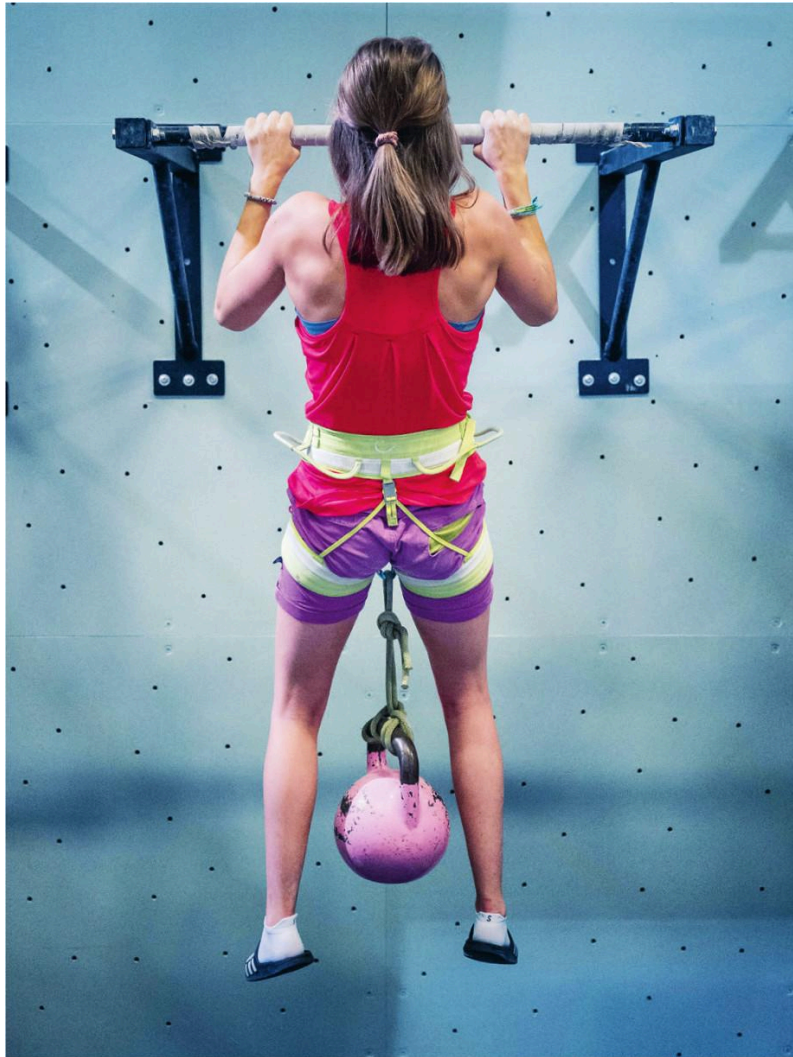
REPETITIONS: 8 to 12

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and even throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: <3 RIR



WEIGHTED

When you're able to do regular pull-ups and have a good margin for each of the three sets at 12 repetitions, a natural progression is to make each repetition harder and reduce the number of repetitions. Ideally you will have tested what your maximum strength is for one repetition (known as one rep maximum, or 1RM) and will perform each set with a load that is above 85 percent of that. If you haven't tested your maximum strength, you can use RIR as a measurement, and for this exercise you shouldn't have more than one repetition in reserve per set.

REPETITIONS: 4

NUMBER OF SETS: 4

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: try to pull as hard and fast as possible, even if the weight makes you move slowly

MARGIN PER SET: 0 to 1 RIR



JERKS

The goal here is to complete each repetition as fast as possible. Start with your arms slightly bent and pull up as fast as you can, then slowly lower down and repeat. To stimulate the speed, you can deload using an elastic band to achieve so-called *superspeed*, and thereby achieve a higher speed throughout the movement.

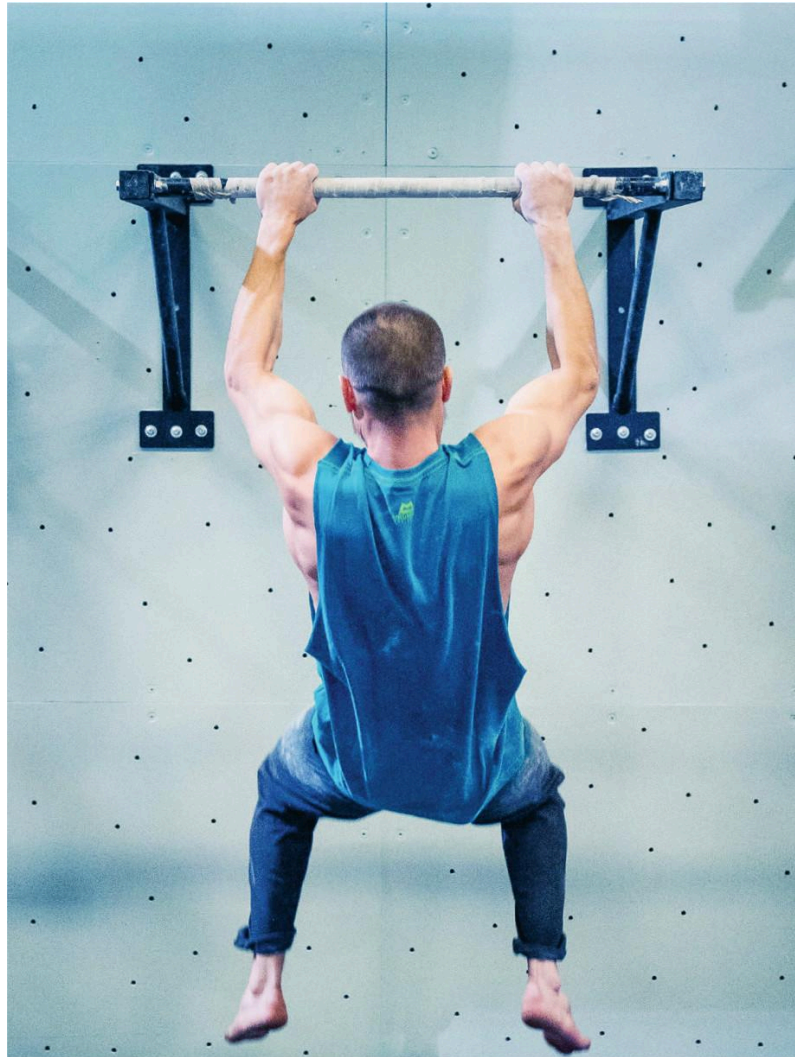
REPETITIONS: 3 to 6

NUMBER OF SETS: 4

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: as fast as possible

MARGIN PER SET: you want to have margin to complete a lot more repetitions, but should complete the set when the speed drops



NEGATIVE

A negative pull-up is when you lower from the top position down on to straight arms. This involves slowing down the movement instead of initiating it – so-called eccentric training. For less experienced climbers this can be a good supplement to doing your first pull-up, while more experienced and stronger climbers can use negative pull-ups as a good method to aggressively stimulate muscle growth and take further steps in their training. It's important to remember that eccentric training is quite a strenuous form of training which can lead to severe muscle soreness, so be careful.

REPETITIONS: 2 to 8

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 1 to 2 RIR



As an example, start with one to two repetitions in sets of three once per week, and gradually increase to eight repetitions in sets of three, twice per week.



ARCHER PULL-UPS

Pull up and lock off in the top position. Move from side to side while alternating straightening out your arms. This means your bent arm will have to take most of your weight while your other arm is straight.

REPETITIONS: 4

NUMBER OF SETS: 4

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 2 RIR



CLAP

Do a pull-up as fast as you can, let go at the top of the movement and clap your hands. Vary the angle you land in – the longer you're in the air, the less bend you will have in your elbows as you land.

REPETITIONS: 4 to 6

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: as fast as possible

MARGIN PER SET: you want to have margin to complete a lot more repetitions, but should complete the set when the speed drops



ONE-ARM PULL-UP

Position yourself sideways below the bar and do a one-arm pull-up. We recommend first deloading to properly learn the technique and maintain control throughout the movement. A pulley system is ideal as it will ensure an even load throughout the movement.

REPETITIONS: 2 per arm

NUMBER OF SETS: 4 per arm

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 1 RIR

COMBINATIONS

In addition to training both finger strength and arm/upper body strength individually, it's good to combine them in the same exercise. We can do this by doing pull-ups on varied grips and in different positions, or through campus training.



FINGERBOARD PULL-UPS

Vary the grip positions for each set, so that you train pull-ups on edges, pockets and slopers. The holds should be so bad that you're unable to do more than four to six repetitions per set, and because they are bad you will need to remain calm and in control so that you don't slide off the holds.

REPETITIONS: 4 to 6

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 0 to 1 RIR

GRIP TYPE: varied



OFFSET

Offset means your hands are gripping holds at different heights. This is in many ways closer to the movement pattern we face while climbing and therefore it's a good exercise for training pulling strength in different positions. The bigger the difference in width and height between the holds, the harder the exercise will be. We also recommend varying the grip type used for the exercise. If, for example, you want to train pinches, choose pinches for both hands. You can also choose a poorer hold for the upper hand and a jug for the lower hand, and vice versa, to vary which part of the movement is the hardest.

REPETITIONS: 4 to 8

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 0 to 1 RIR
GRIP TYPE: varied

CAMPUS

For fully grown climbers, it's possible to keep campus training as a relatively safe training method by learning proper technique and maintaining a reasonable progression. First and foremost, it's important to learn the moves on the campus board, and for most climbers the best way to do this is to stand on footholds below the board and practise the moves.

It's natural to begin with shorter moves on the best campus rungs, and then increase the distance between the rungs before finally moving on to shallower rungs as you gain control.



STRENGTH

Campus training is an effective method for training finger strength as well as arm and upper body strength, in addition to training technical elements like coordination and dynamics. To train strength and to learn the technique of the moves, we recommend starting with relatively good rungs and calm movements. After a while you can increase the distance between the rungs, before moving on to shallower rungs. A strength training session can look something like this:

Warm up by doing exercises with your feet on the wall.

START BY DOING: 1-3-5 x3 reps per arm, with a 60-second rest between each repetition. Rest for 3 minutes.

THEN: 1-3-6 x2 reps per arm, with a 60-second rest between each repetition.

FINISH WITH: 1-2-3-4-5-6-7 x3 reps, with a 60-second rest between each repetition.

POWER

When we use the campus board for power training and finger contact strength we wish to create as much speed and cover as much distance as possible in every move. You can start by using deep rungs and work on pulling as far as you can, then move on to shallower rungs.

START BY DOING: 1 to max height **single** x3 reps per arm with a 60-second rest between each repetition. Rest for 3 minutes.

THEN: 1 to max height **double** x6 reps with a 60-second rest between each repetition. Rest for 3 minutes.

FINISH WITH: 1-2-3-4-5-6 x3 reps at max speed, with a 60-second rest between each repetition.



DOUBLE DYNOS ON THE CAMPUS BOARD

Double-dynoing on the campus board is one of the hardest and most difficult moves we can do. Training this way can yield good results, however it is also a training method that is closely related to a risk of injury. We therefore recommend double dynos only to experienced climbers who have a well-established training foundation and who have already undergone systematic campus training at lower levels of difficulty. Young athletes should hold off campus training until they are fully grown because of the risk of injury to the bones in the fingers.



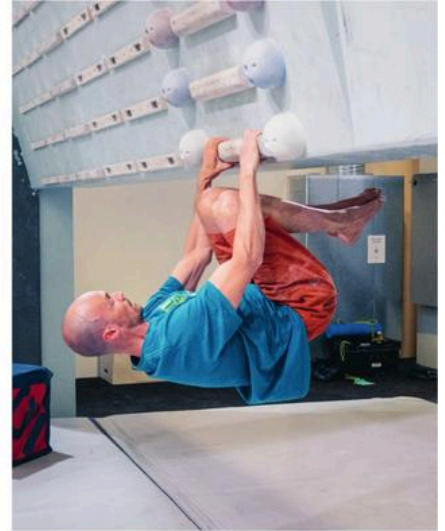
Campus training should be performed early in the session when you are fully warmed up, but not yet too fatigued, so you can execute the training with a high level of quality. Regular climbing should wait till after the campus training.



Quarter front



Half front



Tucked front



One-legged front



Full front

FRONT LEVER

The front lever is a classic exercise in climbing and has almost become the symbol for body strength. Through the different variations of training towards a perfect front lever, your body strength will improve. You'll become better at holding swings, better at placing your feet back on the wall, and better at maintaining body tension between your fingers and your toes. For all the variations, the goal is to maintain straight arms, pulling your chest up towards the hold, and maintaining a straight and rigid body. This becomes harder the more horizontal your body is, and therefore the natural starting point is the [quarter front](#) before moving up the ladder of difficulty to the [full front](#). You can use hang time as a measure of intensity, and when you're able to hang in a position for 15 seconds you can move on to the next level.

HANG TIME: 5 to 15 seconds

NUMBER OF HANGS PER SET: 1

NUMBER OF SETS: 4

REST BETWEEN SETS: 2 to 3 minutes

MARGIN PER HANG: none



FRONT LEVER **PULL-UP**

Doing a pull-up while hanging in a front lever position is probably an exercise reserved for only the strongest among us, but it can be a nice variation to just hanging statically in the position. Doing this while in the full front lever is not only extremely hard, but also extremely difficult because of the balance of your body. If you do train the front lever pull-up, we recommend doing it while hanging in a quarter, half or tucked front lever.

REPETITIONS: 4 to 8

NUMBER OF SETS: 3

REST BETWEEN SETS: 3 minutes

SPEED: calm and controlled throughout the movement

MARGIN PER SET: 0 to 1 RIR



PHOTO: MARTIN MOBRÅTEN

Tina Johnsen Hafsaas climbing *Sin Perdón* (F8b+), Perles, Spain.

VARIATION IN TRAINING

TINA JOHNSEN HAFSAAS is Norway's best female competition climber, with a third place in the World Youth Championships and a fourth in a lead world cup as her standout results, in addition to being many times over the Norwegian and Nordic champion. She performs equally well outdoors, with multiple ascents of F8c+ routes and

Font 8a+ boulder problems. Tina has been training and climbing as an elite athlete since she was only 14 years old. We asked her to share some of her thoughts around variation of specific training.

When I was 15, I was asked if I wanted to start to train. To be coached. Until then I had only climbed. I was at the climbing wall almost every day, doing what I wanted to do and what my friends did. I climbed outside when I had the chance, and had started competing abroad, but most of all I just climbed a lot. I was that young girl who could fly up most of the crimpy boulder problems but would hang for ages on routes and would struggle as soon as the climbing got physical. And people took notice. Stian grabbed me one day and asked me if I wanted a coach. I was curious and soaked it all up like a sponge. Not just from him, but from everything and everyone around me. I read a lot, asked a lot of questions and dug around wherever I could. This would turn out to be one of the biggest advantages of having a coach – having a sparring partner. Discuss, experiment, analyse, and ditch whatever didn't work. Not all the advice a small girl gets from random older men at the wall is good advice.

In terms of training we quickly addressed my physique: I had to climb steeper and harder and build a solid body that in the long term would be able to handle a lot of hard training. I had to learn to climb using four fingers and to keep my shoulder high; I had to gain the physique needed to pull through and create momentum without two holds to pull on; and I had to learn how to try really hard. We shifted most of my climbing over to steeper walls, the moves became bigger and the style more athletic. To work on the aforementioned things, new boulder problems were made that forced me to climb with four fingers and where I had to land holds with my shoulder high. Lead sessions became harder and steeper, and I continued at a high volume. After a while I was introduced to campus boarding and specific finger training, something which has been important to my development.

By mostly focusing on physical climbing, combined with a change in style in competition climbing, my weakness today is modern technique. 'New school' elements are frequently borrowed from bouldering and brought into lead climbing, and as I've grown up with steep climbing on mostly positive holds, I'm now faced with a challenge. This involves more sessions on technically challenging boulder problems, seeking out large holds where I have to position myself lower than I'm so very used to, and also spending energy and skin on pure bouldering sessions when I'm at comps and training camps abroad. This new style is here to stay. I have to adapt to it.

Over the years I've found exercises I've stuck with and always go back to, but it's still important to me to try new exercises and new training methods. Not too long ago I asked Stian why it was me he approached that time nearly 10 years ago. It was my curiosity, he replied. In hindsight, now that I'm a coach for younger athletes myself, I realise that this is exactly what is important – being curious about moves, beta, training exercises and everything else that climbing entails. And to dare. Try, fail and do better, again and again.